

INSTITUTIONAL
INVESTOR



11th Annual RIA Central Investment Forum

June 25-26, 2025
Park Hyatt Hotel Chicago



Synopsis

The RIA Central Investment Forum 2025, presented by Institutional Investor, is the premier event for professionals in the RIA industry. Scheduled for June 25-26 at the Park Hyatt Chicago, this day and a half event gathers leading Registered Investment Advisors from across the US and Canada to engage in discussions on asset allocation strategies, the impact of macroeconomic issues on investment decisions, and methods to improve operations and client satisfaction.

Through panel discussions, breakout sessions, and roundtables, attendees will delve into the most critical industry topics such as the expanding role of private market investments within client portfolios, tax-efficient solutions for highly concentrated allocations, and navigating the growth in industry consolidation

The Forum provides RIAs with the insights needed to make informed decisions that not only benefit their clients but also streamline and enhance the operational aspects of their practices, ensuring they remain competitive and effective in a dynamic financial advisory landscape.

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Debra Brennan Tagg, President, **BFS Advisory Group**

Shari Reiches, Founding Principal, **Rappaport Reiches
Capital Management, LLC**

Agenda

Wednesday, June 25, 2025

7:30 a.m.

Attendee Registration and Breakfast

Foyer

8:30 a.m.

Introduction and Mobile Application Tutorial

Petite Salon

Presenter:Lauren Feldman, *Executive Director, Global Head of Wealth Management, Institutional Investor***Co-Chairperson Welcome and Interactive Polling Session****Featuring:**Debra Brennan Tagg, President, **BFS Advisory Group**Shari Reiches, Founding Principal, **Rappaport Reiches Capital Management, LLC**

8:45 a.m.

OPENING PANEL

Are Trump 2.0, Jay Powell and the AI Revolution Causing a Tectonic Shift in Markets?

Petite Salon

The second Trump Administration has started off with many new changes being implemented and many more being proposed that will have a material impact on the global and domestic economies, respectively. All the while, Jerome Powell and the FOMC are in a bit of a quandary. Strong economic numbers and persistently high prices have put a halt to their projected rate cuts for 2025. And it seems like the buzzword AI is making its way into every corner of our daily lives, creating extreme emotions ranging from euphoria to disappointment in the financial world.

- What impact will Trump 2.0's policies have on the economy and financial markets, asset classes and sectors?
- How many interest rate cuts should investors anticipate for the remainder of 2025 and in 2026?
- What opportunities have arisen and are likely to crop up from the explosion in AI-related companies in both the public and private space?
- Are private or public assets better positioned to benefit from these shifts and market expectations?
- Will we see a return of the IPO market and M&A activity?
- Is volatility expected to return to public markets?

Moderator:Karim Ahamed, Partner, **Cerity Partners****Panelists:**Yussef Gheriani, Chief Investment Officer, **IHT Wealth Management**Steve Kolano, Chief Investment Officer, **Integrated Partners**Jonathan Hubbard, Managing Director & Lead Strategist for Capital Markets, Investment Solutions Group, **MFS**Shannon Saccocia, Chief Investment Officer – Wealth, **Neuberger Berman**

9:30 a.m.

DEBATE

Are Investors Getting Adequate Risk Premiums and Transparency for Private Market Investments Relative to Public Market Assets?*Petite Salon*

We have heard discussions about public versus private market investments make the rounds. The recent increase in volatility in public markets and the proliferation of private market investments into new pockets of the economy has added fuel to the debate. Public equities have seen some impressive returns over the last couple of years, but they are trading at high multiples and facing headwinds. All the while, some private assets are facing headwinds of their own, with areas like middle market private credit being overcrowded and some private equity funds finding challenges with their exit strategies.

- Where are investors more comfortable allocating capital today, given the current market and potential economic challenges?
- Which pockets of private and public markets are offering client portfolios stability in these volatile markets?
- Have private market assets more buffered against short term volatility, or will the challenges faced by public markets catch up?
- Are the fee structures of private market investments consistent with the level of risk and the quality of the underlying investments?
- Is the “crowded investment” assumption a fallacy or are we seeing too much money chasing too few deals?

Moderator:Ingrid Lee, Senior Advisor, **Moneta Group****Panelists:**Derek Schwartz, National Sales Manager, Senior Managing Director, **CION Investments**Ethan Berkebile, Director of Investment Research, **HBKS Wealth Advisors**Kurt Nye, CIO, Managing Partner, **MAI Capital**Kevin Sierra, Principal, Investor Relations, **Stonepeak**

10:15 a.m.

Coffee Break*Foyer*

10:45 a.m.

Morning Breakout Series – Part 1

(Each attendee can choose one 30-minute breakout to attend from one series)

Breakout Session I*Drawing Room I***Financing Everyday Life: Opportunities in Real Assets**

Whether they are required to build infrastructure, fuel data centers or supply our daily dosage of caffeine, energy, industrial materials, and food are integral to our everyday lives. Producing, processing, and transporting those essential goods requires significant capital. As banks continue to reduce their lending activities to this asset class, private lenders have stepped in to fill this gap through Asset-Backed Financings (ABF). As a subset of private credit, ABF allows lenders to provide financing to a diversified set of hard assets and offers diversified, downside-protected structures that mitigate risks through strong documentation, credit enhancements, and diversified collateral. The ABF market today is large and underserved (trade finance, for example, is a \$9.7 trillion market) and provides opportunities for investors with the navigational skills required to benefit from an asset class decoupled from the financial markets. A changing investment climate may add to the impetus for diversifying cash flows backed by a differentiated asset class that is in demand every day by 8 billion people.

Presenter:Ahmad Al-Sati, Partner, Portfolio Manager, **Gemcorp Capital**

Breakout Session II

Drawing Room II

Making Sense of the Real Estate Market

Policy actions over the last several months have led to significant market volatility and have dampened consumer sentiment. While real estate has not been immune, data would suggest opportunity ahead in certain property types and geographic markets. This session will explore the dynamics underpinning the current real estate landscape and how the confluence of capital markets, fundamentals and property attributes may contribute to go-forward opportunity across major sectors.

Presenter:Mark Roberts, Managing Director and Head of Research, **Crow Holdings**

11:15 a.m.

Track Change

11:20 a.m.

Morning Breakout Series – Part 2

(Each attendee can choose one 30-minute breakout to attend from one series)

Breakout Session III

Drawing Room I

Maximizing Potential Private Equity Returns Through Operational Expertise

The private equity market is primed for robust deal activity and strong performance in 2025 and beyond. With moderating interest rates, stabilizing valuations, and asset owners more willing to sell, opportunities are growing. However, the formula for success is evolving. With rates still well above pre-pandemic levels, financial engineering through cheap debt is no longer a given.

Join David Nowak, Managing Partner at Brookfield Private Equity, as he discusses why he believes operational expertise is key to driving excess returns. Learn why investing with private equity managers who have access to large-scale capital, a proven track record of operational improvements, and rigorous due diligence is critical in today's evolving market.

Interviewer:Barbara Borozan, Senior Vice President, Head of RIA Channel, **Brookfield Oaktree Wealth Solutions****Interviewee:**David Nowak, President, **Brookfield Private Equity****Breakout Session IV**

Drawing Room II

Lower Middle-Market Private Credit & Secondaries

Dive into the prospects of private debt as an asset class, focusing on the factors driving its rapid growth – potential challenges and opportunities ahead.

Presenter:Brett Hickey, Founder & Chief Executive Officer, **Star Mountain Capital**

11:50 a.m.

Track Change

11:55 a.m.

REAL ESTATE

The Best Way to Get Exposure to Real Estate Right Now: Equity v Credit and Public v Private Markets**Petite Salon**

The higher for longer interest rate environment has taken its toll on real estate assets. Many existing commercial properties have seen higher cap rates, some have traded at steep discounts, and funding new projects has become challenging. The residential market has not been as hard hit, but there are signs of a slowdown in some markets. The key to both segments are interest rates and prices, which have yet to budge. The good news is that there are some green shoots for real estate, such as the growing demand for data centers and the push for return to the office by many companies.

- Which segments within the real estate asset class are showing promise through the remainder of 2025 and into 2026?
- What happens if interest rates do stay higher for longer? Will the appeal still be there?
- Which types of vehicles do wealth managers recommend their clients to get exposure to real estate assets in the current environment? Publicly traded funds or private funds?
- What proportion of portfolio allocation do advisors recommend for clients and is real estate's allocation facing some pressure from other better-performing assets?

Moderator:

Matt Peden, Senior Director of Investments, **True North Advisors**

Panelists:

Gary L. Rozier, Senior Member, Real Estate Investment Team, **Blue Owl**

Jack Ablin, Founding Partner and Chief Investment Officer, **Cresset**

Trey Morsbach, Debt Platform Leader and Executive Managing Director, **JLL**

Julia Butler, Chief Executive Officer, **KKR Real Estate Select Trust Inc.**

12:40 p.m.

Seated Lunch

Drawing Room I & II

2:00 p.m.

IN-DEPTH DISCUSSION

How are Advisors Hedging their Clients' Public Asset Portfolios Against Concentrated Positions and Increased Market Volatility?**Petite Salon**

Given how positive markets have been over the past couple of years, it's difficult to imagine a scenario where tail risks are suddenly triggered. However, the unwinding of the carry trader in the wake of the Bank of Japan's rate hike in the summer of 2024 and the calamitous decline of Nvidia shares after the introduction of the Chinese AI tool DeepSeek demonstrate that shocks are still possible and that it is wise to hedge against concentrated positions.

- What are the hidden risks in markets that wealth managers are paying close attention to?
- What are advisors telling clients that are hell-bent on chasing the frothiest of investments, such as the Mag 7?
- What are wealth managers doing to prevent concentration risk among highly saturated positions?

Moderator:

Daniel Kern, Chief Investment Officer, **Nixon Peabody Trust Company**

Panelists:

Elliott Wellenbach, SVP, Institutional ETF Strategist, **Direxion**

Brian Andrew, Chief Investment Officer, **Merit Financial Advisors**

Adam Recker, Head of Equities, Senior Managing Director, **The Mather Group**

Ayako Yoshioka, Portfolio Consulting Director & Sr. Investment Strategist, **Wealth Enhancement Group**

2:45 p.m.

Track Change

2:50 p.m.

Afternoon Breakout Series*(Each attendee can choose one 30-minute breakout to attend from one series)***Breakout Session V**

Drawing Room I

The Evolution of Private Credit and the Search for Alpha

Private credit has become a staple within portfolios over the last decade and fundraising trends reflect just that. Dan Cohn-Sfetcu, Managing Director at FS Investments, will discuss how the market has evolved from his vantage point and how his team focuses on harder to access segments of the market in search of alpha.

Interviewer:Daniel Kern, Chief Investment Officer, **Nixon Peabody Trust Company****Interviewee:**Dan Cohn-Sfetcu, Managing Director, **FS Investments****Breakout Session VI**

Drawing Room II

Solving for Your Client's HNW Challenges

Serving HNW clients takes more than investment expertise—it requires a holistic approach centered on personalization, tax efficiency, and risk management. In this session, we'll explore the most common challenges faced by HNW investors and how Canvas helps advisors solve them with precision and scale. Going beyond traditional Direct Indexing, Canvas integrates capabilities like tax loss harvesting, options overlays, and municipal bond ladders—all within a single platform and managed account. Discover why top advisors rely on Canvas to transform complex wealth strategies into scalable, repeatable solutions.

Presenter:Christian Boinske, Client Portfolio Manager, **Canvas Custom Indexing**

3:20 p.m.

Coffee Break

Foyer

3:40 p.m.

PRACTICE MANAGEMENT**Does Your Practice Have the Strategy and Tools to Face the Great Wealth Transfer?**

Petite Salon

Cerulli Associates estimates that approximately \$70 trillion will be inherited first by spouses (mostly women) then by future generations (Millennials and Gen Z) over the next 21 years, one of the most significant financial shifts in history. Advisors should not automatically expect to inherit that business. As high as 70% of widows leave their current advisors. And it is as high as 90% for the next generation leaving their parents' advisors. It is crucial to build and maintaining trusted relationships with both spouses, and then continuing that trusted relationship into the next generation. Advisors' competitors are clamoring for this business, so what can RIAs do to make that they can keep that business in-house?

- How has the demand from clients started changing based on shifting demographics?
- How have RIAs and their firms been preparing for this massive shift in wealth?
- What have advisors found to be the most successful ways to establish and maintain a strong and fruitful relationship with their clients?
- How are advisors best engaging the next generation and what challenges have they faced?
What have RIAs changed within their practice to address these challenges?

- What kind of costs should a firm expect to incur in order to adapt to these changes? Has there been a learning curve and how onerous has it been?

Moderator:

Tiffany Irving, Senior Vice President, Wealth Advisor, **Mesirow Wealth Management**

Panelists:

Mimi Duff, Managing Director, Head of New York Office, Advisor, **GenTrust**

Shari Reiches, Founding Principal, **Rappaport Reiches Capital Management, LLC**

Craig Robson, Founding Principal and Managing Director, **Regent Peak Wealth Advisors**

Brent Coggins, Chief Investment Officer, **Triad Wealth Partners**

4:25 p.m.

PRIVATE CREDIT

The Next Frontier for Private Credit: Diversification, the Secondaries Market, and Expansion into Broader Investor Segments

Petite Salon

The push into private markets has never been more pronounced than today, particularly private credit. Even in the face of economic uncertainty, private credit continues to be the darling of all asset classes, with an aggressive push even into the retail space.

- In which sectors of the lending world is private credit making a push into next?
- Has private credit experienced in increase in payment-in-kind arrangements being triggered? What have been the predominant causes?
- How active is the secondaries market? What have been the primary advantages of finding investments in the secondaries market?
- Has recent market and economic volatility caused concern among investors and what are the best and worst case scenarios?

Moderator:

Andy Vantine, Director of Credit Strategy, **FLP Atrato Consulting**

Panelists:

Victoria Greene, Founder & Chief Investment Officer, **G Squared Partners**

Scott Hall, Managing Director, **Jefferies Private Wealth Management**

Alona Gornick, Managing Director, Senior Investment Strategist, **Churchill Asset Management**

Ted Katramados, Director/Associate Portfolio Manager, **TAG Associates**

5:10 p.m.

PRACTICE MANAGEMENT

Smoothing Out Transitions and Growth: Post-Merger Team and Client Integration, Talent Retention and Technology Adoption

Petite Salon

The wealth management space has been incredibly active when it comes to mergers and acquisitions. The trend is not projected to stop any time soon. This can be very lucrative for sellers, however, melding the two operations, staff and clients can also be a very complex undertaking. It can also lead to a mismatch among investment strategies, management, staff, operations, as well as technology platforms.

- What are the key factors in the vetting process that the two firms undergo?
 - Are there pre-set provisions for potential shortcomings?
 - Which shortcomings are more often expected than not?
- What is done to retain staff post-merger? Is a certain amount of voluntary attrition already baked into the plan?
- Do owners prefer to sell to a competitor/peer or to an investment firm? Which is often better for the RIA firm?
- What do firms do in the area of technology mismatches? Can more be done by industry tech providers?
- How are investment style and asset preference mismatches resolved?

- When does the M&A bonanza cycle come to an end?

Moderator:

Debra Brennan Tagg, President, **BFS Advisory Group**

Panelists:

John Nicholas, Partner, **Chicago Partners Wealth Advisors**

Kate Redden, Vice President of Client Experience, **Merit Financial Advisors**

Jonathan Sarver, Managing Partner, Wealth Advisor, Senior Portfolio Manager, **Sarver Vroom Wealth Advisors**

5:50 p.m.

Cocktail Reception

Foyer

Thursday, June 26, 2025

7:45 a.m.

RIA Central Think Tanks and Breakfast Session

Drawing Room I & II

Think Tank 1

AI in 2025 – Hype vs Reality and Where We Are Heading

Moderator: Kevin Burke, Partner, Head of Strategy, **Sapphire Ventures**

Think Tank 2

How Do Advisors Manage and Execute Effective Communications with Clients During Times of Concern and Increased Market Volatility?

Moderator: Kate Redden, Vice President of Client Experience, **Merit Financial Advisors**

Think Tank 3

Legacy or Liquidity: When Do You Hold on to Your RIA Firm and When Do You Sell?

Moderator: Dimitri Eliopoulos, Chief Executive Officer, **RMB Capital**

Think Tank 4

Hiring the Next Generation in Wealth Management

Moderator: Jonathan Sarver, Managing Partner, Wealth Advisor, Senior Portfolio Manager, **Sarver Vroom Wealth Advisors**

Think Tank 5

The Evolution of the RIA: Ancillary Services to Satisfy Today's Clients' Needs

Moderator: Natalia Tchetchoulina, Partner, **Cerity Partners**

8:40 a.m.

Day 2 Co-Chairs' Welcome Remarks

Petite Salon

Co-Chairs:

Debra Brennan Tagg, President, **BFS Advisory Group**

Shari Reiches, Founding Principal, **Rappaport Reiches Capital Management, LLC**

8:45 a.m.

INFRASTRUCTURE

Beyond Bridges and Highways: How the Infrastructure Class Has Evolved and is Gaining Traction Among Investors

Petite Salon

For the longest time, infrastructure investments have been associated almost exclusively with bridges, toll roads and highways. The evolution of the global economy towards a digital world and the need to connect everyone is creating infrastructure opportunities that were unimaginable a mere decade ago. From internet and mobile device connectivity to power generation and transportation, the need for capital to fulfill these projects is in the trillions.

- What opportunities in the infrastructure space are available for wealth management clients?
- How long are investment commitments typically and what are some of the potential risks associated with infrastructure assets?
- What form of exit/liquidity strategies exist and how onerous are penalties?
- What kind of due diligence goes into ensuring the financial validity of projects?

Moderator:

David Solow, Managing Director, Client Advisor, **Caprock**

Panelists:

Jake Kelsall, Principal, **StepStone Group**

Ilya Nassonov, Senior Vice President, Investment Solutions, **Macquarie Asset Management**

Ayako Yoshioka, Portfolio Consulting Director, Sr Investment Strategist, **Wealth Enhancement Group**

9:30 a.m.

Coffee Break and Networking

Foyer

10:00 a.m.

PRIVATE EQUITY

Private Equity Investors: Rattled by Recent Economic Jitters or Resilient and Looking for Opportunities?

Petite Salon

The recent “high stakes poker game” of international trade policy poses a threat to most businesses around the globe. If the situation is aggravated and sustained, it has the potential to cause strain in PE investments due to cost pressures and exit delays. However, the private equity ecosystem is a lot broader than in previous years and offers interesting ways to gain exposure to the asset class.

- How will fundraising be impacted, particularly for wealth clients who may have incurred deep losses across other holdings and don’t wish overexposure to one asset class?
- Will continued global trade pressure boost opportunities in the secondaries markets as some investors seek to exit current positions?
- Can NAV lending provide a stopgap for companies that would have otherwise exited via an M&A or IPO until valuations can come back? What are the potential risks if the trade pressure persists?
- Will the market see an increase in continuation funds should the trade war persist? How do LPs feel about extending their exposure to these investments for a longer time period?

Moderator:

Matt Dmytryszyn, Chief Investment Officer, **Composition Wealth**

Panelists:

Matt Rubin, Chief Investment Officer, **Cary Street Partners**

Steve Dean, Chief Investment Officer, **Compound Planning**

Chris Armstrong, Director of Research, **Merit Financial Advisors**

Christopher Graff, Partner, Chief Investment Strategist, **RMB Capital**

10:45 a.m.

TAX STRATEGIES

Creative Strategies that RIAs are Implementing to Help Their Clients Through Onerous Tax Bills

Petite Salon

Many wealth management clients have benefitted from the spectacular market performance over the last few years. Most notably, the meteoric rise of the Mag 7 stocks. Many of these investors wish to access some of their capital, however, liquidation can result in quite onerous taxation. More often than not, wealth management clients are looking to their advisors for solutions to their concentrated positions at a minimal penalty?

- What kind of tools are RIAs using to minimize tax burdens?
 - Tax harvesting
 - 351 Exchange ETFs
 - Asset location
 - Holding periods
- What is the next generation of tax mitigation tools that advisors foresee?

Moderator:

Kirk Wilkerson, Regional Director, Partner, **Merit Financial Advisors**

Panelists:

Emily Shacklett, Director, Practice Group Leader, Wealth Advisor, **Fairport Wealth**
Mark Parthemer, Chief Wealth Strategist & Florida Regional Director, **Glenmede**
Josh Rogers, Senior Client Portfolio Manager, Custom Equities Team, **Invesco**
Bridget Fagerholt, Managing Director & Chief Compliance Officer, **MAS Advisors**

11:30 a.m.

CRYPTOCURRENCIES

New Horizons: Does Crypto Belong in Client Portfolios Now That the Broader Industry is Taking the Asset Class Seriously?*Petite Salon*

Bitcoin has, once again, made an all-time high, touching \$112,000. The speed at which the broader investment industry, including a handful of pension funds, asset managers and government agencies are embracing Bitcoin and crypto is accelerating. What the evolution of the asset class over the long run looks like has yet to be seen, but it is becoming clear that if investors do not have exposure to crypto in their respective portfolios, they are missing out on potential gains.

- How much client interest are RIAs seeing in the crypto space?
- With such a broad universe in the crypto space, where should RIAs place their focus?
- Which vehicles are best utilized to gain exposure and what percentage of a client's portfolio do RIAs recommend for getting exposure?
 - What are the advantages and disadvantages of investing in crypto ETFs versus holding native crypto assets?
 - What are the pros and cons of cold storage versus third-party custody?
- How is the tokenization of assets outside of cryptocurrency potentially going to change the investment landscape?
 - How will stablecoins and new legislation impact crypto investors?

Moderator:

Jacqueline Campbell, President, Chief Executive Officer and Senior Wealth Advisor, **Alexander Legacy Private Wealth Management**

Panelists:

Matthew Snider, Chief Investment Officer, **Digital Wealth Partners**
Christopher Haigh, Chief Executive Officer & Financial Adviser, **Iconoclastic Capital Management**

12:15 p.m.**Closing Lunch***Drawing Room I & II*
